

Problem 6: Epic Greek Poetry

Solution:

- In the given verses, each line contains 17 syllables.
- The Dactylic Hexameter differentiates between two different kinds of syllables. They can be referred to as “heavy syllables” and “light syllables”.
- Each syllable contains at least one vowel and may contain consonants on either side of the vowel.
- If multiple vowels are present continuously in a single word, they are grouped together in a single syllable except when the first of the two vowels is marked by a circumflex.
- A syllable is ‘heavy’ if one of the vowels in the syllable is marked with a circumflex (like â, ê, î, ô, û). If not, the syllable is ‘light’.
- If ‘L’ represents a “light syllable” and ‘H’ represents a “heavy syllable”, then the pattern of syllables in each line is:

HLL | HLL | HLL | HLL | HLL | HL

In other words, each line contains 5 feet of the form “HLL” and 1 foot of the form “HL”.

Assignment 1: Do the verses follow the *Dactylic Hexameter*?

Verse Number	Y/N
a)	N
b)	Y
c)	Y
d)	N
e)	N